

Assignment: Create a Video Game

Develop an original idea for a video game. You do not need to create artwork, write code, or design detailed gameplay systems. Your goal is to communicate a clear and interesting game concept in English.

Imagine that you are going to show this idea to a group of investors. You want to convince the investors to give you money to develop your game!

Answer the following questions in complete sentences.

Part 1: Inspiration

1: What has inspired your game idea?

Name one or two games, movies, TV shows, books, comics, anime, or other media that influenced your idea. What do you like about these influences? How does your game use ideas from them?

For example, Eric Barone was inspired by Harvest Moon when he made his game, Stardew Valley.

Influence 1: _____

My first influence is _____. I like _____ about it. I want to use _____ ideas from it.

Influence 2: _____

My first influence is _____. I like _____ about it. I want to use _____ ideas from it.

2. What makes your game different?

Even if your game is inspired by something else, explain one or two unique features or ideas. Your game may be similar to your influences, but it should be a unique, new idea.

What is new or unusual about your game?

Why would players want to play your game?

Part 2: The Core Idea

3. What is the basic concept of your game? What is the core fantasy? What is the gameplay loop?

Describe your game in 2–4 sentences.

Imagine someone asks: "What is your game about?"

4. What is the setting?

What is the setting of your game? Where does the game take place?

Examples:

- Modern city
- Fantasy kingdom
- Space station
- Underwater world
- Historical period
- A haunted house

Describe the **atmosphere**. For example, is it a fun, relaxing 'cozy game', or a scary horror game?

5. What role does the player play?

How does the player interact with the game? Does the player control a character? Or does the player have a 'bird's eye view' of the game world?

Describe the role the player has, or the character or characters that the player controls. Who are they? What is their role in the world? Why are they important?

Part 3: Goals and Player Experience

6. What is the player's main goal?

What is the player trying to accomplish? If the player can win, how do they win the game?

Examples:

- Save a kingdom
- Build a village and make the villagers happy
- Explore unknown planets and learn about alien life
- Solve a mystery or puzzles
- Survive in a dangerous environment

7. What is the mood of the game? How should players feel when they play your game?

Games often have a mood that they create for players. Choose two or three feelings and explain why.

Examples:

- Relaxed
- Excited
- Curious
- Scared
- Powerful
- Creative

8. Who is the target audience?

What kind of people would enjoy playing this game? Why would they like it? Explain your choice in 2-4 sentences.

Examples:

- Children
- Teenagers
- Adults
- Casual players
- Competitive players
- Fans of science fiction stories

9. What themes does the game explore?

Like the mood of a game, the games themes are an overall idea that affects the player's experience. What theme or themes does your game explore?

Examples:

- Environmental problems
- Loneliness
- The horror of war
- Childhood
- Space exploration
- Cultural understanding

10. Game Mechanics and Unique Features

Do you have a specific game mechanic in mind for your game? If it is not a game mechanic, then what is a unique feature of your game?

Examples of game mechanics:

- The player catches monsters and trains them (Pokemon)
- The player catches ghosts with a vacuum (Luigi's Mansion)
- When the player dies, they have one chance to retrieve the points they lost (Dark Souls)
- The player uses various tools to repair an abandoned farm (Harvest Moon)

Part 4: Final Touches

11. Working Title

The working title of my game is _____.

Give your game a title. This is a 'working title', which means that it might change later.

12. Genre

Does your game fit into a genre of games? For example, action, RPG, adventure, puzzle game, cozy game, strategy game, etc.

13. The Pitch

Summarize your game idea in 50 - 100 words. Briefly explain the main idea, features, mechanics, and so on.